

Notes 1. Occupational Health and Safety

According to Wikipedia, **Occupational Health and Safety (OHS)** is a multidisciplinary field concerned with the health and safety of people at work.

Occupational Health and Safety is the discipline dealing with the prevention of work-related injuries and diseases as well as the protection and promotion of the health of workers.

It aims at the improvement of working conditions and environment.

The goal of an occupational health and safety program is to foster a safe and healthy occupational environment.

OHS also protects all the general public who may be affected by the occupational environment.

According to International Labor Organization, **Occupational Health and Safety** is a discipline with a broad scope involving many specialized fields.

In its broadest sense, it should aim at:

- the promotion and maintenance of the highest degree of physical, mental and social well-being of workers in all occupations;
- the prevention among workers of adverse effects on health caused by their working conditions;
- the protection of workers in their employment from risks resulting from factors adverse to health;
- the placing and maintenance of workers in an occupational environment adapted to physical and mental needs;
- the adaptation of work to humans.

In other words, occupational health and safety encompasses the social, mental and physical well-being of workers; that is the "whole person".

Successful occupational health and safety practice requires the collaboration and participation of both employers and workers in health and safety programmes, and involves the consideration of issues relating to occupational medicine, industrial hygiene, toxicology, education, engineering safety, ergonomics, psychology, etc.

(Source: https://training.itcilo.org/actrav_cdrom2/en/osh/intro/inmain.htm)

Definitions:

Occupational: relating to job or profession - job related - work related.

Safety: the state of being safe; freedom from the occurrence or risk of injury, danger, or loss.

Safety is being aware of your surroundings, recognizing risks and threats, and making sure that you, and those around you, go home in one piece.

Health: is a state of complete physical, mental, and social well-being.

Health is not merely the state of being free from illness, disease or injury, it is a state of complete physical, mental, and social well-being.

Well-being: is the state of being comfortable, healthy, or happy.

Well-being can be understood as how people feel and how they function, both on a personal and a social level, and how they evaluate their lives as a whole.

One useful way of measuring well-being is the Warwick-Edinburgh Mental Well-Being Scale (WEMWBS).

This is a scale of 14 positively worded items, designed to measure both the feelings and functioning aspects of positive mental well-being.

Participants are asked to choose the answer that best describes their experience of each item over the last two weeks, using a five point scale.

The end result is a score between 14 and 70, with a higher score indicating better well-being.

(Source: <https://warwick.ac.uk/fac/sci/med/research/platform/wemwbs/>)

WEMWBS vs SWEMWBS: 14-item vs 7-item scale -

<https://warwick.ac.uk/fac/sci/med/research/platform/wemwbs/about/wemwbsvsswemwbs/>

There are two versions of the Warwick-Edinburgh Mental Wellbeing Scale. Both scales are considered to be robust and valid when applied in population, community, educational, occupational and clinical settings. The choice you make will depend on your study needs.

The Warwick-Edinburgh Mental Well-being Scale (WEMWBS)

Below are some statements about feelings and thoughts.

Please tick the box that best describes your experience of each over the last 2 weeks

STATEMENTS	None of the time	Rarely	Some of the time	Often	All of the time
I've been feeling optimistic about the future	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ 5
I've been feeling useful	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ 5
I've been feeling relaxed	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ 5
I've been feeling interested in other people	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ 5
I've had energy to spare	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ 5
I've been dealing with problems well	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ 5
I've been thinking clearly	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ 5
I've been feeling good about myself	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ 5
I've been feeling close to other people	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ 5
I've been feeling confident	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ 5
I've been able to make up my own mind about things	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ 5
I've been feeling loved	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ 5
I've been interested in new things	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ 5
I've been feeling cheerful	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ 5

Warwick-Edinburgh Mental Well-Being Scale (WEMWBS)
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The Short Warwick-Edinburgh Mental Well-being Scale (SWEMWBS)

Below are some statements about feelings and thoughts.

**Please tick the box that best describes your experience of
each over the last 2 weeks**

STATEMENTS	None of the time	Rarely	Some of the time	Often	All of the time
I've been feeling optimistic about the future	1	2	3	4	5
I've been feeling useful	1	2	3	4	5
I've been feeling relaxed	1	2	3	4	5
I've been dealing with problems well	1	2	3	4	5
I've been thinking clearly	1	2	3	4	5
I've been feeling close to other people	1	2	3	4	5
I've been able to make up my own mind about things	1	2	3	4	5

"Short Warwick Edinburgh Mental Well-Being Scale (SWEMWBS)

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Wellness - (Source: <https://www.pfizer.com/health-wellness/wellness/what-is-wellness>)

Wellness is the act of practicing healthy habits on a daily basis to attain better physical and mental health outcomes, so that instead of just surviving, you're thriving.

Several key areas of your lifestyle are considered dimensions of overall Wellness.

They include: **social connectedness, exercise, nutrition, sleep and mindfulness.**

4 Dimensions of Wellness - (Source: <https://www.edwards.af.mil/About/4DW/>)

Spiritual Wellness

Spiritual strength is that force that drives us to make sacrifices for others, our nation, and the greater good. It may come from religious faith, heritage, experience within our community, influence of role models, or other sources of inspiration.

Emotional Wellness

Emotional wellness refers to building an awareness of and accepting one's feelings and moods. It includes finding ways to encourage positive thinking and acceptance of oneself.

Physical Wellness

Physical wellness includes expanding your knowledge about your lifestyle and how food, good nutrition and physical activity can be an integral part of your lifestyle.

Social Wellness

Social wellness entails being cognizant of the impact you and your actions have on your community, the society and nature.

Wellness Checklist:

Spiritual Wellness

- Do you set aside time in your day for prayer, meditation, or personal time?
- Do you set aside time in your day for relaxation/quiet time?

Emotional Wellness

- Are you able to make decisions/complete activities with minimum stress/worry?
- Is there something you are looking forward to?

Physical Wellness

- Do you participate regularly (min 3X/week) in an aerobic activity?
- Do you get adequate and satisfying sleep, and wake up refreshed?
- Do you need to work on issues related to nutrition?

Social Wellness

- Do you set aside and plan time to be with your family and friends?
- Do you feel that your relationships are positive and rewarding?
- Are you involved in group activities or hobbies?

If you answer is "no" to any of these questions, then let's meet Solace - The Wellness Experts.

[solace.live](#) - an employee wellbeing startup - at National Incubation Center (NIC), NED.